

## Winzip

The most widely used file compression software is owned by Corel.

## Take it easy

Be it any software or tool, initial preparation is vital when attempting sketching or drawing. Start with fine lines, and get bolder as you proceed.

Bazaar

# Corel Painter 11

## Different Strokes

Corel's Painter is meant for 2D artists who normally use a canvas and painting and drawing tools to create artwork. The interface hasn't changed a lot from previous versions. One of the nice features of Painter is the mixer window that lets you add and mix colours like they would in a real palette. Painter even lets you use different kinds of canvas and there are some brushes like the watercolours that won't work on regular canvas.

Thankfully, layers are present so you can separate bits and pieces of a painting. The watercolour and spray paints spread on paper like they would in real life. So, there is very good attention to detail and at the same time, it makes Painter good fun to use.

There is no shortage of brushes and there are plenty of presets for each kind of brush. The application is really simple to get used to and layout is more or less like any other image editor. There is basic provision for creating animations as well. Although, painters don't usually use effects tools, there are the basic effects such as blur and color tone changing tools in Painter.

The improvements and additions to this version are basically a few brushes. There is a noticeable improvement in performance. We tried on different systems including a Pentium 4 with a gigabyte of RAM and it ran perfectly fine. We also had the Wacom Intuos 4 tablet with us for review and it worked well with Painter.



Painter 11 is excellent for anyone deeply interested in painting and sketching. There are a few alternatives but Painter is probably the most matured one of the lot. A slightly simpler and open interface would be nice. The price of Rs. 25,000 is steep but despite it, this software is a must-have for anyone in the 2D art industry or a lot of interest in the art form.

## Requirements

Windows XP or Vista, 700MHz processor or higher, 1 GB RAM, 500 MB disk space.

## Contact

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Price: Rs. 25,000

## RATINGS

|                       |     |
|-----------------------|-----|
| Features .....        | 8   |
| Performance .....     | 8   |
| Ease of use .....     | 6.5 |
| Value for money ..... | 5.5 |
| Overall .....         | 7   |

# Wacom Intuos 4

## Different strokes

The Intuos 4 has a set of controls on the left and a fine display next to the controls. It also has a touch-sensitive pad that lets you zoom in and out or rotate the canvas. More functions can be accessed by pressing the centre button. The controls of the Intuos are perfectly designed so that you don't have to use your keyboard while using the tablet. The shortcuts are handy while panning or changing settings for your brushes in applications such as Adobe Photoshop and Corel Painter.

The performance is impressive if you haven't used a tablet before. The strokes don't feel very smooth and there might be some skipping while putting long quick strokes. Sometimes, you have to slow down for the tablet to perfectly capture your inputs. The precision button allows slightly slower, but more accurate tracking.

The Wacom Intuos 4 supports 2048 levels of pressure so you while drawing you can actually press down on the pen more to get a darker stroke like you would with a real pen and paper. To keep things very realistic, there are nibs with different feels and pressure sensitivity provided with the package. It's the 2D artists which include those who sketch, paint or do some kind of touch up work who will find tablets such as this most useful. Artists who've been using brushes and pens on paper won't feel right at home. Slight adjustments to styles and techniques along with some time getting used to will be needed before you can be comfortable



with it. The advantages of using any software and the flexibility that this gives makes it well worth the effort.

Overall, it's a great tool to have. Anyone with an inclination towards 2D art will find it amazing to use. The medium sized Intuos 4 is priced at Rs. 21,280 and the small one is priced at Rs. 14,000. Although a little expensive for someone learning painting, it's a good long-term investment for professionals and everyone into painting and touch up work should use one.

## Contact

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Price: Rs. 21,280 (Medium)

## Specifications

Pressure level: 2048

Tilt sensitivity: 60 degrees

Dimensions (Medium):

370 x 254 x 12 mm

Usable area:

223.5 x 139.7 mm

Weight: 1 kg

## RATINGS

|                       |     |
|-----------------------|-----|
| Features .....        | 7.5 |
| Performance .....     | 7   |
| Build Quality .....   | 7   |
| Value for money ..... | 6   |
| Overall .....         | 7   |